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July 17, 2024

Mauren Isleib, Director
Office of Residential Life
41 Wyllys Avenue
Middletown, CT 06459

Dear Ms. Isleib:

I am deeply interested in the Residential Assistant position at The Office of Residential Life. I have always loved serving others and building close communities, and the Office of Residential Life's work in ensuring the academic, emotional and social well-being of Wesleyan students by creating safe communities aligns perfectly with my interests and passions. After speaking with Venessa Ochieng, a current member of your Student Staff team, I was compelled by the office's emphasis on promoting inclusivity in living spaces for all Wesleyan students, regardless of their gender, race, or sexual orientation. I would love to join in extending this mission to my peers. My communication skills, interpersonal skills, and emotional intelligence will contribute to my success as a Residential Assistant.

Relevant to the position, this past spring I worked as the Hospitality Manager at my Leadership Academy's student-led Church. I organized five community-building activities to help members know each other better and led a team of five ushers to create a welcoming and ambient environment for Sunday Morning Service every week for twelve weeks. These experiences taught me consistency and dependability in serving as a leader, as I had to provide an example and encouragement for my fellow ushers to carry out their responsibilities as best as they could. I also learned the invaluable skill of intercultural inclusion, as I organized these events to cater to the cultural integration of 50 church members from 20+ African countries. The events ultimately witnessed many testimonials of meeting a loving and welcoming community upon arrival, from both first and second-year members during our church leadership feedback sessions. Most importantly, they taught me the impact of creating a supportive community.

I also provided emotional support and counselling to the 20 incoming first-year students of the church, helping them transition into the demanding environment of the leadership academy. I answered any questions they had and provided a listening ear for any concerns or challenges they were facing. This role taught me emotional dependability, emotional intelligence, and a high level of interpersonal engagement and professional discretion, as I had to be approachable enough for students to feel comfortable being vulnerable with me, offer institution-based guidance to difficult situations, and keep all shared information confidential, except with the relevant school safety authorities. Further, studying consistently and maintaining good grades as a student during my time as a Hospitality Manager taught me to be self-motivated and hard-working, and helped me find clever ways to be efficient in my school work, while also providing support to my peers.

I am confident these skills and experience will enable me to promote a positive community standard as a Residential Assistant and would welcome the opportunity to interview. Please find my resume enclosed with this email. I can be reached at nivie@wesleyan.edu. Thank you in advance for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Naomi Ivie